



Configure GlassFish, code
an application and deploy it
on the application server.

What's in the Glass(Fish)?

Part 2: Getting Started With the App Server

Last month, we discussed application servers, and in particular, the GlassFish app server. This month we will look at how to get started with GlassFish version 2 on Debian GNU/Linux. For other distributions, the procedure will be almost the same.

Installation of GlassFish

GlassFish v2 requires JDK 1.5 or a later version. So if you are using Fedora 9 or Ubuntu 8.4, you already have OpenJDK 6. You can check the version of Java with the `java -version` command at a terminal prompt. This command will print the available version of Java on your system. For example, on my system the available version of Java is 1.4.2 as can be seen from the following terminal output:

```
mca05@debian:~$ java -version
java version "1.4.2"
gjl (GNU libgcj) version 4.1.2 20061115 (prerelease) (Debian 4.1.1-20)
```

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So I have to install JDK 1.5 or later before installing and configuring GlassFish. Verify that your `/etc/apt/sources.list` file has the following entries and you are connected to the Internet:

```
deb http://security.debian.org/ etch/updates main contrib non-free
deb http://ftp.debian.org/debian etch main contrib non-free
deb-src http://ftp.debian.org/debian etch main contrib non-free
```

Then simply run the following command:

```
apt-get install sun-java5-jdk
```

It will install JDK 1.5 or above on your system. Now that we